

Which brings us to the benefits of, well, the Jetpack project. As you'll notice by the size of the table that follows, there are many. The most striking part is the platform-agnostic nature that you get when you use it. That means, you can develop for all Firefox platforms, desktop and mobile, which is a big plus in that the developer need not know the intricacies of the platforms, but only the kind of APIs available for that particular target build. This layer of abstraction is in very active development at the moment, and is only expected to get better as it moves into the later stages of being a complete product. Of course, we've talked at length about how simple (and most importantly, centralised) it seems, in comparison to other ways of add-on development. This streamlining is very important to have the developers constantly engaged and interested in the platform, not that Mozilla has to worry about the opposition any time soon.



Now with a friendlier development environment!

Another very important benefit that standardisation of the development process does is that it enforces rather than allows the use of best practices on development. It's not entirely impossible to go wrong with the SDK – that would be a fatal underestimation of well, just how wrong one can go when playing with computer bits. But, still, you're going to have to try hard to do that. Of course, because the entire interaction is with APIs, better security could be maintained, which previously integrated add-ons have sometimes been accused of compromising on. No such worries here, as only the essentials are exposed. And, with restartlessness built in, it eliminates some degree of work that needed to be done by the user in order to take his newest toy for a drive. All in all, the experience is more wholesome, and the process is beneficial for both, external developers and the Firefox team, while the users get access to the same innovative extensions that have always set the bar in terms of delivering the best browser experience.

But then, in our humble opinion, Jetpack is what add-on development should be. For years, if there's one thing you could accuse Firefox of, it would be the assumption that for developing for Firefox you needed plenty of